

Organic Kalettes Information Pack

Introduction

Kalettes are a cultivar blend of curly kale and Brussel sprouts growing on the vine that was developed by a British seed company to suit our climate and market. Nutritionally, Kalettes are particularly valued for their vitamin C content, which contributes to immune function and helps with iron absorption, and vitamin K, which plays a key role in blood clotting and bone health. They are also a useful source of folate (vitamin B9), supporting normal cell division and making them especially relevant in diets focused on overall wellbeing.

Farm Information

Your kalettes come from Bedlam organics in Cambridgeshire. It is run by Clive and Tobias Martin, a father and son team. The land put into organic conversion in 2006 and the business has never looked back. The wide variety of soils on the fens lends itself to diverse cropping, as certain crops are better suited to certain soil types and conditions. Kalettes are hardy and actually taste better after exposure to frost which softens some of the brassica bitterness. They are heavy feeders, meaning they require rich and fertile soils hence why they have flourished on the fens.

Bedlams maintains this natural soil fertility using classic organic methods, composting heavily and tilling minimally. This is a larger scale organic farm than Laines, so the pest protection and fertility building practices are on a larger scale but follow the same principles.

Like other brassicas, Kalettes contain glucosinolates — natural plant compounds associated with antioxidant activity and long-term health benefits. They also supply minerals such as potassium, which supports normal muscle and nerve function, along with smaller amounts of calcium, magnesium, and iron.